



# DISASTER MANAGEMENT IN DEVELOPMENT

India is vulnerable, in varying degrees, to multiple natural disaster. Vulnerability to Chemical, Biological, Radiological and Nuclear (CBRN) emergencies and other man-made disaster has also increased manifold in the recent past.

Disaster risks in India are further compounded by increasing vulnerabilities related to changing demographic and socio-economic conditions, unplanned urbanization, development within high-risk zones, environmental degradation, climate change, geological hazards, epidemics and pandemics. Clearly, all these contribute to a situation where disaster seriously threaten India's economy, its population and sustainable development.

Based on the recommendations made by several committees and in the wake of tsunami in December, 2004, the Government of India took a defining step by piloting the enactment of the Disaster Management Act 2005, which envisaged the creation of the National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA), headed by the Prime Minister of India.

There is an emerging consensus that the key to achieving sustained reduction in disaster losses lies in factoring risk considerations into development activities. Managing risks could become a means of reducing future disaster risks through 'corrective' development planning which ensures, through measures such as land-use planning, building controls and others, that development activity does not generate new risks.

Disaster Management (DM) has, not been sufficiently highlighted in the policies and programmes of various plan schemes. The country's commitment to 'Mainstreaming DM into the process of development planning at all levels, so as to achieve sustainable development, is yet to be carried forward across various sectors.

Mainstreaming disaster management into the development planning process essentially means looking critically at each activity that is being planned, not only from the perspective of reducing the disaster vulnerability of that activity, but also from the perspective of minimizing that activity's potential contribution to the hazard.

Government of India has become one of the first national Governments to

operationalise the mainstreaming of disaster management in development plans, as envisaged by the Hyogo Framework for Action.

## MAINSTREAMING OF DISASTER MANAGEMENT IN DEVELOPMENT PLANNING

There are three ways of mainstreaming disaster management into developmental process. These include:

(a) Structural Measures (b) Non Structural Measures. (c) Launching of National Level Mitigation Projects.

### STRUCTURAL MEASURES

In the structural measures there are three ways to build in DM concerns.

#### New projects / programmes

All new projects/programmes should be revisited to build in DM concerns with regard to disaster. This would entail-

- (a) Ensuring that all new critical infrastructure projects like power, water, communication etc compulsorily comply with the safety standards of disaster resilience.
- (b) The implementation of techno-legal regimes such as Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) codes and the NDMA's guidelines on various disaster.
- (c) Selectively ensuring that all existing infrastructure projects are retrofitted from future disaster, to the extent possible

#### Ongoing projects / programmes

The design of ongoing projects/programmes will also need to be similarly audited to ensure that the completed portion (such as infrastructure like flyovers etc and including building) will need to have structural additionalities to ensure resilience to specific disaster to which the locations concerned are vulnerable.

#### Projects / programmes already completed

These would have to be revisited selectively on priority. The manner of undertaking such an exercise is dealt with, in considerable detail in the NDMA's guidelines, especially those relating to the management of Earthquakes, Cyclones and Floods.

### NON STRUCTURAL MEASURES

The Non Structural Measures for mainstreaming Disaster Management into development plans include legislations and other such instruments as